Seung Yeon Lee

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EDUCATION

Yonsei University, Seoul, Korea Mar 2024– Aug 2026 (Expected)

M.S. in Business Administration (Concentration: Quantitative Marketing)

- GPA: 4.27/4.30
- Fully funded scholar of the Accelerated Bachelor-Master's Program
- Recipient of the BK21 Four Research Fellowship (Korea National Research Fellowship)

Yonsei University, Seoul, Korea Mar 2019–Feb 2024

B.B.A in Business Administration & B.A. in Library and Information Science

- GPA: 4.15/4.30; ranked third in class
- Awarded the Humanities 100-Year Scholarship, granted to top 0.2% undergraduates nationwide

Exchange Student, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (Free University of Amsterdam), The Netherlands Fall 2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Substantive: AI Marketing, Marketing Strategies, Digital Platforms, Social Media Analytics
Methodological: Structural Models, Machine Learning, Causal Inference, Quasi-experiments, Field Experiments

PUBLICATIONS (ABSTRACTS IN APPENDIX I)

Seung Yeon Lee, Chaehyeon Lee, and Sue Ryung Chang (2025), "The Impact of Co-Production Partnerships on Film Success: The Moderating Role of Participating Countries and Cultural Differences," *Journal of the Korea Entertainment Industry Association, 19*(1), 1-12.

Seung Yeon Lee, Chaehyeon Lee, and Sue Ryung Chang (2024), "The Impact of Positive Emotional Valence in Webnovel Blurbs on Its Success," *Journal of the Korea Contents Association, 24*(3), 206-217.

- Estimated Tobit regression models showing that positive emotional valence in blurbs increases viewership, with effects moderated by blurb length and author popularity
- Constructed a dataset of 4,637 webnovels via web crawling and fine-tuned a pretrained Korean BERT model for sentiment analysis on webnovel blurbs

WORKING PAPERS AND PAPERS UNDER REVIEW (ABSTRACTS IN APPENDIX II)

"The Effect of AI Incidents on Social Media Engagement" with Dr. Sue Ryung Chang

Master's thesis, Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Journal of Marketing*

- Developed the research question and conceptual framework, collected AI incident data to examine the nature of the effects of AI incidents on Instagram engagement
- Extracted emotional scores from brand posts through text analysis and performed structural equation modeling addressing endogeneity concerns

"The Effect of AI-Generated Fitting Models on Purchase Intention" with Miju Ahn and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang

Under review at *Marketing Letters* (SSCI, Impact Factor 2.5)

- Designed and ran experiments to test consumer evaluations of fashion brands using AI-generated fitting models
- Led hypothesis development, experimental execution, and statistical analysis using mediation and moderation frameworks via PROCESS macro in SPSS

"The Influence of a Firm's Track Records in Strategic Collaboration: Exploring the Interaction of Past Performance and Partner Composition in Box Office Performance" with Chaehyeon Lee and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang
Manuscript in preparation for submission to *Strategic Organization* (SSCI, Impact Factor 3.8)

- Examined how film companies' economic and artistic track records affect box office success by building and analyzing a 25-year dataset of 14,000+ films released worldwide
- Estimated Tobit regression models to assess how experience level and experience diversity among co-producing companies shape the effectiveness of co-production partnerships

"Competitive Spillovers of a Firm's IPO: Evidence from Digital Content Platform" with Chaehyeon Lee and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang
Under review at *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing* (SSCI, Impact Factor 11.6)

- Contributed to early-stage idea refinement and conceptual framing for examining IPO-driven spillover effects in digital content platforms
- Conducted literature review and provided feedback on the manuscript drafts to improve clarity and coherence

WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant
Marketing Strategy (Yonsei University, Undergraduate Course) — Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Growth Marketing Assistant Intern — Aug 2024
FINDA (Fintech platform)

- Executed CRM campaigns and search ad optimization projects, and improved CTR and app-store visibility through A/B-testing

14th Asian Leadership Conference (ALC) Secretariat Intern — Mar 2023–May 2023
Chosun Daily

- Served as English-speaking liaison at Korea's leading news company for high-profile speakers, including former UK Prime Minister *Boris Johnson* and former U.S. Congressman *Theodore Yoho*, coordinating logistics to facilitate a seamless appearance
- Produced English and Korean written content for the official website and brochures, including speaker introductions and session descriptions

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"The Effect of Contextual Size in Online Images on Purchase Intention for Hedonic Foods" — July 2025

- 2025 Korean Strategic Marketing Association Spring Academic Conference

"The Influence of a Firm's Track Record in Strategic Collaboration" — Nov 2024

- 2024 International Conference of Asian Marketing Associations (ICAMA)

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

Scholarships
Korea National Scholarships

- Brain Korea 21 FOUR Research Fellow — Mar 2024–Feb 2026 (Expected)
- Brain Korea 21 Junior Research Fellow — Feb 2024
- Humanities 100-Year Scholarship (full tuition scholarship) — Mar 2022–Feb 2024

Yonsei University Scholarships

- Accelerated Bachelor-Master's Program Scholarship (full tuition scholarship) — Mar 2024– Feb 2026 (Expected)

Awards

- *Third Prize, Academic Thesis Competition*, Yonsei University Graduate School — Nov 2025
- *Best Presentation Paper Award*, Korean Strategic Marketing Association — May 2025
- *International Research Excellence Award*, Korea Marketing Association — Nov 2024
- *Finalist, Business Innovation Contest*, KMAC — Nov 2024
- *Class MVP Award*, Yonsei School of Business — Jun 2022
- *Dean's List*, Yonsei University — Fall 2021, Spring 2022

RELEVANT COURSES

(* indicates graduate-level courses)

Marketing and Business

- Quantitative Marketing Seminar*, Strategic Marketing Management*, Marketing Decision Models*, Seminar in Marketing*, International Marketing*, Experimental Methodology in Marketing*, Marketing Proseminar on Consumer Behavior*, Marketing, Consumer Behavior, Relationship Marketing

Economics, Statistics and Others

- Econometrics 1*, Big Data Analytics and Statistical Analysis*, Business Analytics 1*, SW Programming, Principles of Macroeconomics, Fundamentals of Economics, Statistics in Library and Information Science, Introduction to Statistics, Information Retrieval, Studies in Social Network Service, Information Technology

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

- **Data Analysis**: R, Python, SPSS, SAS, Qualtrics, Tableau
- **Languages**: English (fluent), Korean (native), Spanish (intermediate, DELE B1)

PERSONAL INTERESTS

Running (10 km races); hiking and taking long urban walks; traveling and exploring food culture

REFERENCES

Sue Ryung Chang • Associate Professor
Yonsei University, Department of Marketing
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Chang Hee Park • Associate Professor
Yonsei University, Department of Marketing
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Seoungwoo Lee • Assistant Professor
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Youjung Jun • Assistant Professor
Yonsei University, Department of Marketing
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APPENDIX I. ABSTRACT OF PUBLICATIONS

The Impact of Co-Production Partnerships on Film Success: The Moderating Role of Participating Countries and Cultural Differences

with Chaehyeon Lee and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang

Published in *Journal of the Korea Entertainment Industry Association*, February 2025

Co-production, where two or more production companies participate in the filmmaking process, has become increasingly common in the film industry. While co-production allows production companies to secure production funding and broaden distribution networks, it also presents potential risks, such as conflicts arising from differences in production techniques and cultural disparities. Despite the significance of co-production in the film industry, empirical research analyzing its impact on box office performance remains limited. Thus, this paper focuses on investigating how the number of participating production companies impacts a film's box office performance. We analyze a dataset comprising 6,724 films released worldwide over the past decade. A Tobit regression model is employed to explore the impact of co-production on a film's box office performance. The results reveal that, first, the number of production companies participating positively affects a film's box office performance. Second, this positive effect is weakened by the number of participating countries. Third, the effect is also diminished by the differences in the perception of power among these countries. By highlighting the importance of shaping effective co-production partnerships that account for cultural differences among the participating companies, our study provides filmmakers, investors, and marketers valuable insights to enhance collaboration and refine strategic decision-making in the film industry.

The Impact of Positive Emotional Valence in Webnovel Blurbs on Its Success

with Chaehyeon Lee and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang

Published in *Journal of the Korea Contents Association*, March 2024

With the recent rapid growth of the webnovel market, it is crucial to understand the factors contributing to the success of webnovels. While the "webnovel blurb," which summarizes key information about each webnovel, significantly influences consumer decision making, there is limited research investigating the effect of blurb features on novel success. Therefore, this study examines the impact of the emotional valence of webnovel blurbs on novel views. We measure the emotional tone of each blurb using KoBERT (Korean language-based emotion analysis model) and employ a Tobit regression model for analysis. Our findings reveal that a positive emotional tone in blurbs positively impacts novel views. However, this effect is mitigated by the length of the blurb and the number of views of the author's previous work.

APPENDIX II. ABSTRACT OF WORKING PAPERS AND PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

The Effect of AI Incidents on Social Media Engagement: The Moderating Effect of Brand's Social Media Posting Activity
with Dr. Sue Ryung Chang
Master's thesis, Manuscript in Preparation for Submission to *Journal of Marketing*

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has become deeply embedded in organizational operations, with 88% of firms reporting AI use in at least one business function (McKinsey & Company, 2025). As AI use increases, AI-related incidents such as technical malfunctions, privacy leaks, and other failures, have also increased. The 2025 AI Index Report by Stanford HAI showed a 56.3% rise in globally reported AI incidents between 2023 and 2024. News about such incidents spreads rapidly through newspapers and social media, amplifying public attention and prompting critical questions about their potential impact on companies and their brands.

Social media, where consumer reactions form rapidly and visibly, plays a central role in shaping brand evaluations. Positive engagement such as likes reinforces favorable brand associations, whereas absent or negative engagement weakens them. AI incidents may trigger both penalties and heightened curiosity: while some consumers distance themselves from the brand, others intensify their monitoring during periods of technological uncertainty. Despite the growing relevance and importance, empirical evidence on how real-world AI incidents influence consumer engagement on social media is limited. Prior research on AI incidents focuses largely on financial consequences such as stock returns, cash flow, or bankruptcy risk, without examining consumer responses or the communication environments in which these reactions occur. This study addresses these gaps by investigating two research questions: (1) How do AI incidents influence consumer engagement on brand-owned social media accounts? (2) How does a brand's social media posting activity moderate these effects?

We construct a panel dataset that tracks each brand on a daily basis, using two primary data sources. First, AI incident records were collected from a large-scale global incident database that categorizes failures reported in more than 150,000 global news articles per day, yielding over 4,000 incidents from 2018 to 2024. Second, we obtained proprietary daily Instagram analytics for follower counts, average likes, and post metadata for Interbrand's 100 Best Global Brands, about 60 percent of which experienced at least one AI incident during the observation window. To capture short-term dynamics, we compute rolling seven-day changes in average likes and follower counts and measure AI incidents, news volume, and posting activity using the same seven-day windows. Posting activity is conceptualized along two dimensions: posting volume, which increases account visibility and information load, and posting arousal, which reflects the affective intensity conveyed in captions. We estimate moderated mediation models using structural equation modeling with brand and month fixed effects.

The findings demonstrate that AI incidents significantly influence consumer engagement on social media, but differently across the two engagement metrics. AI incidents decrease weekly changes in average likes, indicating immediate declines in positive reactions, while increasing weekly changes in follower counts, suggesting that heightened monitoring. News coverage mediates these effects, amplifying the decline in average likes and stimulating additional follower interest. However, the magnitude and direction of these effects depend on the brand's posting activity. Higher posting volume consistently worsens incident spillovers by suppressing the positive indirect effects on likes and diminishing follower gains. Post arousal plays an asymmetric role: it intensifies negative engagement reactions yet helps sustain follower interest, indicating that affectively charged content can heighten backlash while maintaining attention.

This study offers the first large-scale empirical evidence on how real-world AI incidents shape consumer engagement on social media, showing that such incidents generate both evaluative penalties and heightened attention. By distinguishing between average likes and follower counts and demonstrating how posting activity conditions these dynamics, the study advances understanding of consumer responses to AI-related risks. Practically, the results highlight that brands can influence incident spillovers not only through direct crisis response but also through their everyday communication environment. Careful calibration of posting frequency and emotional tone in social media can mitigate negative reactions while helping sustain audience attention during periods of heightened AI incidents.

The Effect of AI-Generated Fitting Models on Purchase Intention
with Miju Ahn and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang
Under Review at *Marketing Letters*

As AI technology advances, fashion retailers are adopting generative AI to create realistic fitting model images, replacing time and cost intensive photoshoots and offering practical solutions in the fast-moving retail environments. Despite its benefits, AI-generated model images may appear overly polished, inauthentic, or emotionally detached, raising concerns about their impact on brand perceptions. Thus, we examine the effects of using AI-generated fitting models on brand trust and purchase intention. Across two experimental studies, we find that AI-generated fitting models significantly reduce brand trust compared to human models. This reduction in brand trust mediates the negative effect of AI-generated fitting model images on consumers' purchase intentions. Furthermore, the negative effect of AI-generated fitting model images becomes more pronounced for low-involvement products. Our findings contribute to the growing marketing literature on consumer responses to AI and offer actionable insights for fashion brands seeking to integrate generative AI into their marketing visuals.

The Influence of a Firm's Track Records in Strategic Collaboration: Exploring the Interaction of Past Performance and Partner Composition in Box Office Performance
with Chaehyeon Lee and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang
Manuscript in Preparation for Submission to *Strategic Organization*

Co-production is widely used in the film industry to manage project uncertainty. While prior research emphasizes the financial and innovative benefits of co-production, little is known about how the resources and capabilities of co-producing firms influence performance of co-produced films. This study examines how economic and artistic past performance of film production companies impacts current film success, and how these effects vary depending on the experience level and variability among co-producing firms. Using a 25-year dataset comprising 14,303 films with Tobit regression models, we find that both the economic and artistic past performance of co-producing companies positively impact box office revenue of the film. Furthermore, these effects are enhanced or mitigated by the composition of the co-production companies. These insights deepen the understanding of the strategic role of co-production partnership composition, providing practical guidance for companies seeking to foster successful co-production in the film industry.

Competitive Spillovers of a Firm's IPO: Evidence from Digital Content Platform
with Chaehyeon Lee and Dr. Sue Ryung Chang
Under Review at *Journal of Research in Interactive Marketing*

The expansion of the digital content market has prompted many digital content platforms to consider launching initial public offerings (IPOs) to secure capital and enhance their market visibility. IPOs are generally associated with positive performance effects for the issuing firms and a negative impact on competitors. This relationship may manifest differently in the digital content platform industry due to its distinctive characteristics that allow consumers to use multiple platforms concurrently. This study investigates the impact of an IPO on the marketing performance of digital content platforms, focusing on both the issuing firm and its competitors. Our findings reveal that IPOs not only increase website traffic for firms going public but also boost traffic for competing platforms, indicating a spillover effect. Further analysis shows that this effect is mediated by increased attention to both the IPO firm and its competitors. These results highlight the broader market implications of IPOs in the digital content platform industry, demonstrating their role in shaping consumer and investor attention.